

Peak 11 Media

Payments & Collections SOP

The complete money flow: how Peak 11 quotes, collects, receipts, refunds, and books every dollar through Stripe. Updated June 2026.

1. Purpose & Core Principle

Peak 11 collects every payment through **Stripe** (the Conscious Mirage / Peak 11 Stripe account). There is one collection channel and one only: an **emailed Stripe payment link**. We never take a card number over the phone, never key a card into a terminal, and never accept cash or app transfers (Venmo/Zelle/CashApp) for client work. This keeps the business inside Stripe's receipts, refunds, and dispute tooling, and keeps us clean under Utah's telemarketing posture.

The Prime Rule: payment is ALWAYS an emailed Stripe link — never over the phone.

Under Utah telemarketing rules we do not collect, request, or read back card details on a call. The close happens on the phone; the **money happens by link**. On the call you say: "I'll email you a secure Stripe link to pay — you'll have it in two minutes." Then send it. No exceptions, even if the client offers to read their card number.

2. BLOCKED — Stripe Key / Login (Nate action required)

The current Stripe secret key is DEAD / revoked. Nothing below can run until this is fixed.

Step 3 (creating products and payment links) requires a live Stripe account. The existing secret key is revoked and no longer authenticates. **This is the one thing only Nate can do:** log in to the Conscious Mirage / Peak 11 Stripe account (or create the account if it doesn't exist), then either (a) generate a fresh secret API key so Claude can build the products programmatically, or (b) confirm login so Claude can build them in the Stripe Dashboard via browser automation. Until a working key/login exists, there is no way to collect a payment.

Once a live key or confirmed login is in hand, the rest of this SOP is fully executable by Claude — product creation, payment links, receipts, dunning, refunds, and bookkeeping all run without further help from Nate.

3. The Stripe Setup (build once)

Create exactly three products in the Peak 11 Stripe account, each with its own shareable payment link. Prices match the Peak 11 offer ladder.

Product	Price	Type	Stripe object
Starter	\$900	One-time	Product + one-time Price + Payment Link
Standard	\$1,200	One-time	Product + one-time Price + Payment Link
Care Plan	\$49 / month	Recurring (subscription)	Product + monthly recurring Price + Payment Link

Build steps (Dashboard or API)

- 1 **Create the 3 products** above. Name them exactly "Peak 11 — Starter Website," "Peak 11 — Standard Website," "Peak 11 — Care Plan." The customer sees these names on the receipt, so they must read clean.
- 2 **Attach prices:** \$900 and \$1,200 as *one-time* prices; \$49 as a *recurring monthly* price. Currency USD.
- 3 **Generate a Payment Link** for each product. These are the three shareable URLs we email. Set each link to collect the customer's name and email, and turn ON "collect billing address" for clean records.
- 4 **For deposits / custom amounts** (e.g. a 50% deposit, or a quote that isn't exactly \$900/\$1,200), use Stripe *Invoices* with a custom line item rather than a fixed payment link — same emailed-link behavior, arbitrary amount.
- 5 **Enable email receipts:** Settings > Customer emails > turn on "Successful payments" and "Refunds." Set the business name, support email, and logo so receipts are branded Peak 11.
- 6 **Enable subscription dunning / Smart Retries** for the Care Plan: Settings > Subscriptions and emails > Smart Retries ON; failed-payment, upcoming-renewal, and card-expiring emails ON. This auto-recovers most failed monthly charges with no manual chasing.
- 7 **Save the three link URLs** into the CRM / playbooks so any future operator sends the right link without rebuilding.

Receipts and dunning are set-and-forget.

Once email receipts and Smart Retries are on, Stripe automatically emails a branded receipt on every payment and automatically retries failed Care Plan charges on an optimized schedule (and emails the client to update their card). You do not manually send receipts or chase failed subscriptions.

4. The Deal Money Flow (every client, in order)

This is the fixed sequence from "yes" to "live site." Do not start building before money is in and the contract is signed.

- 1 **Contract e-signed FIRST.** The client e-signs the Peak 11 agreement (scope, price, deposit terms, refund policy, Care Plan terms) before any link goes out. No signature, no link, no build.
- 2 **Emailed Stripe link.** Send the matching payment link (Starter/Standard) or a custom Stripe invoice for the deposit. Payment is by link only — never phone.
- 3 **50% deposit to start, OR full payment.** Client pays either a 50% deposit (e.g. \$450 on Starter, \$600 on Standard) to kick off the build, or the full amount up front. Build does not begin until that first payment clears in Stripe.
- 4 **Build.** Design and develop the site per the signed scope.
- 5 **Remainder at launch.** Before the site goes live, email the Stripe link/invoice for the remaining balance (the other 50%). Site goes live once the remainder clears.
- 6 **Care Plan subscription starts at go-live.** At launch, send the Care Plan (\$49/mo) payment link. The recurring subscription begins on go-live day and bills automatically every month thereafter.

Stage	What's collected	Trigger to proceed
Sign	\$0 (e-signature)	Contract signed

Start	50% deposit or 100%	Payment clears in Stripe
Launch	Remaining 50%	Payment clears in Stripe
Go-live	Care Plan \$49/mo begins	Subscription active

5. Invoicing, Receipts, Refunds & Chargebacks

Invoicing & receipts

- **Fixed-price work** (clean \$900 / \$1,200 / \$49) goes through the standard **payment links**.
- **Anything custom** (a 50% deposit, a remainder, a one-off add-on) goes through a **Stripe Invoice** emailed to the client — same secure-link experience, any amount, and it shows as a clean line item.
- **Receipts are automatic.** With customer emails enabled, Stripe sends a branded receipt on every successful charge and refund. Never hand-write a receipt.
- **One client = one Stripe Customer.** Always attach payments to the same Customer record so deposit, remainder, and Care Plan all roll up under one client for clean books.

Refund policy

- **Full refund before launch.** If the client cancels before the site goes live, refund what they've paid in full, minus any third-party hard costs already incurred (domain, paid stock) if the contract specifies. Issue it as a Stripe refund on the original charge — never a cash/outside refund.
- **No refund after launch.** Once the site is live and delivered, the build fee is non-refundable. The work is done and handed over.
- **Care Plan is prorated.** The \$49/mo Care Plan can be cancelled anytime; cancel the subscription in Stripe and prorate/refund the unused portion of the current month if the contract promises proration. The subscription then stops billing — no future charges.
- **Always refund through Stripe** so the refund is receipted, reconciled, and reflected in the dispute record.

Chargebacks (disputes) — basics

- A chargeback is the client's bank reversing a charge. Stripe emails you and pulls the funds plus a dispute fee until it's resolved.
- **Respond inside Stripe before the deadline.** Upload evidence: the signed contract, the approved scope, proof of delivery (the live URL), and email correspondence showing the client received the work.
- **Prevention is the real defense:** the signed contract + clear scope + emailed-receipt trail is exactly the evidence that wins disputes. This is another reason every step is e-signed and link-based.
- Use a recognizable Stripe statement descriptor ("PEAK 11 MEDIA") so clients don't dispute a charge they simply didn't recognize.

6. Bookkeeping Hygiene

- **Track revenue against the \$5k/month goal.** Sum collected Stripe payments per month. The dashboard's gross volume is the headline number; reconcile it monthly.
- **Separate one-time vs. MRR.** One-time build fees (Starter/Standard) are project revenue and lumpy. Care Plan (\$49/mo) is **MRR** (monthly recurring revenue) and compounds. Tag every payment as BUILD or CARE so you can see both lines independently.

- **What to hand an accountant** (monthly/quarterly): the Stripe *Balance / Payouts* report, the *Payments* export (gross, fees, net, refunds, disputes), and a simple BUILD-vs-CARE summary. Stripe's built-in reports export this in a few clicks.
- **Watch the net, not the gross.** Stripe takes ~2.9% + \$0.30 per charge. A \$900 build nets ~\$873; a \$49 Care Plan nets ~\$47.30. Book the fee as an expense so profit is accurate.
- **Keep business money separate.** Stripe payouts land in the Peak 11 / Conscious Mirage business account, not a personal account — clean separation for taxes.

Sales tax on Utah services — confirm with an accountant.

Utah generally does **not** tax most professional/personal services, and standalone custom web-design/development is typically treated as a non-taxable service. BUT bundled tangible goods, certain hosting/SaaS, or canned-software elements can change that, and rules shift. **Do not assume.** Before scaling, have an accountant confirm whether any part of the Starter/Standard/Care Plan offering is taxable in Utah, and whether a sales-tax license is needed. Flag this; don't guess on the PDF.

7. Revenue Model — First \$5k and Path to \$20k/mo

The math is simple: one-time builds get you to the first milestones fast; the Care Plan MRR is what makes the number **stick and compound** month over month.

First \$5,000 (a single strong month)

- **4 builds** at an avg ~\$1,050 (mix of Starter \$900 + Standard \$1,200) = ~\$4,200, plus a handful of Care Plans = clears \$5k. Realistically: **4–5 closes** in a month hits \$5k on builds alone.
- **Or 6 Starters** (\$900 × 6 = \$5,400). At a typical close rate, that's a manageable call volume off a verified lead sheet.
- Every build closed should also start a \$49 Care Plan at go-live — that's the seed of recurring revenue, even while builds carry the first month.

How MRR compounds

- Each Care Plan adds \$49/mo that **carries into every future month** with no new selling. 20 Care Plans = ~\$980/mo recurring before you make a single new call that month.
- MRR de-risks the build pipeline: as the recurring base grows, you need fewer new builds each month to hit the same total.
- Care Plan retention is the flywheel — keep clients on the plan (hosting, updates, small edits) and the recurring base only grows.

Path to \$20,000/month

Mix	One-time builds	Care Plan MRR	Monthly total
Build-heavy	~17 builds @ ~\$1,050 = ~\$17,850	~45 plans @ \$49 = ~\$2,205	~\$20,055
Balanced	~12 builds @ ~\$1,100 = ~\$13,200	~140 plans @ \$49 = ~\$6,860	~\$20,060
MRR-mature	~6 builds @ ~\$1,100 = ~\$6,600	~275 plans @ \$49 = ~\$13,475	~\$20,075

The takeaway: early on, \$20k means a punishing ~17 builds/month. As the Care Plan base matures, the same \$20k needs far fewer builds because MRR carries the floor. **Every build closed should plant a Care**

Plan — that's how the business shifts from grinding for builds each month to standing on recurring revenue.

Peak 11 Media — internal SOP. One collection channel (emailed Stripe link), one signed contract, one receipt trail. Blocked only on a fresh Stripe key/login from Nate; everything downstream is fully executable.